

MARTINA NAVRATILOVA

The world's greatest woman tennis player will be in Sydney for the NSW Open on Monday.

KEITH DUNSTAN and
DEBBIE SPILLANE
analyse the Navratilova style.

THE WOMAN

By KEITH DUNSTAN

JUST looking furtively this way and that and just not trying to say it too loudly . . .

I think I am turned on by Martina Navratilova.

Oh, I know what you're thinking. When Martina was at Wimbledon earlier this year there was a Mrs Pam Nelson in the grandstand. *Time* magazine in the old days would have described her as a "great and good friend" or "constant companion Pam Nelson."

That is not the point. Martina Navratilova symbolises the new breed, the athletic woman. If there is one creature I cannot stand it is the model, the anorexia nervosa look.

I saw one on the stage at the Melbourne Regent Hotel recently and she was modelling swim suits . . . I beg your pardon . . . apparently we can't call them bathing togs any more. Anyway, her hip bones were sticking out as if they were about to penetrate the skin. Her arms and legs were like pieces of spaghetti. She was a type of creature designed to inspire the fat matrons of Toorak and South Yarra. Not me.

It's the new breed that's got to me. Last week, I was at the dentist and there was a pile of magazines, including a copy of that way-out German mag, *Stern*. They had a whole feature on American female weight-lifters. The centre spread showed a blonde, clenched fists, arms pulled back, doing the classic muscle flex, and she was stripped to the waist.

Oh friends, she looked fantastic;

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*"Her biceps brachii
is a noble mound . . .
As for her legs,
I stand back
in adoration."*

THE PERFORMER

By DEBBIE SPILLANE*

WHAT Martina Navratilova has done in tennis places her in the ranks of the all-time greats. It's what she hasn't done that has seen her penalised in the popularity stakes.

She has won Wimbledon five times (the past three in succession), three French Opens, two US Opens and one Australian title. In nearly two years she has lost only two matches.

But in terms of popular acclaim she hasn't done the important things in women's tennis such as having herself linked romantically with a player from the men's circuit. Tennis traditionalists also point out that Navratilova hasn't won a real Grand Slam.

By taking out this year's French Open, Navratilova achieved what is recognised officially as a Grand Slam: consecutive victories in the big four tennis tournaments — Wimbledon and the US, French and Australian Opens. But some critics have dubbed her achievement a Grand Sham, claiming those three tournaments must be won in a calendar year — as they were by Maureen Connolly and Margaret Court — for the slam to be valid.

Navratilova can answer those critics by winning the Australian title at Kooyong in December, which she is long odds-on to do. That would give her seven straight Grand Slam event wins, including four this calendar year.

In 11 years on the international tennis scene Martina Navratilova has learnt from every valid criticism of her game. Every shortfall in her temperament,

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